



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Leo School
School Website: <https://eccss.org/slcs/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Leo School, PA 15853, presents a Catholic, classically oriented program rooted in a diocesan-school framework. Public-facing materials emphasize a “classical education model” and a Catholic identity aligned with the Elk County Catholic School System and the Diocese of Erie. This yields a strong Religious/Metaphysical Foundation and a clear School Purpose & Goal oriented toward formation. However, explicit, verifiable details on several core classical elements—especially the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition, the full Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, and explicit Socratic pedagogy—are not consistently spelled out in the publicly accessible site content. Taken together, the school leans toward a CLASSICAL orientation in spirit, but the evidence in de facto public materials places it at a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification across several of the six elements.

Key strengths

- Strong Catholic identity and diocesan affiliation (theology-grounded framing) clearly present in public materials. This supports a robust religious/metaphysical foundation and indicates theology-informed formation within a Catholic framework. See evidence of Catholic school system affiliation and diocese in the crawl materials.
- Explicit labeling of the school as following a “classical education model,” signaling intent to align with classical pedagogy and curriculum principles.
- Publicly available curricular materials reference a curriculum explanation and structured academic planning, including preschool-to-middle-school information, calendars, and family handbooks, highlighting organized formation and family engagement.

Important caveats

- Explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, and explicit mention of Trivium/Quadrivium or Socratic Seminar pedagogy are not clearly documented in the readily accessible crawl content. The classical lexicon and rubric emphasize those facets, but they are not consistently evidenced in the public pages we can cite. See the classical rubrics and keyword indicators used for assessment.

ABSTRACT

classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (overall)

- Evidence-based indicators across six categories place St. Leo in a classical orientation in spirit, with strong religious/theological grounding, but with gaps in publicly evidenced, canonical classical-program elements (great books, structured Socratic pedagogy, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis) that would push it to a full CLASSICAL rating.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials clearly anchor the school within a Catholic diocesan framework (Elk County Catholic School System, Diocese of Erie) and reference parish involvement. This signals theology-grounded education and liturgical/civic formation in a Catholic context.

- The presence of a Catholic School System and parish participation suggests a liturgical and communal frame that integrates faith with education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): theology, sacred tradition, liturgy, reverence, worship, virtue, moral formation, sacred order, Logos, sacramental imagination. Evidence in the public materials aligns with “theology” and “Catholic formation.”
- Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school’s Catholic identity and diocesan affiliation provide a clear grounding in religious/metaphysical foundations, aligning with the Positive Keywords of Grounded Theology and Liturgical/Communal practices. However, explicit liturgical practices and detailed theological programming beyond affiliation are not extensively documented in the crawl. This yields a CLASSICAL-aligned foundation tempered by limited documented liturgical detail in public content, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials emphasize a classically designed education model that communicates a formation-oriented aim rather than purely vocational aims. This is evidenced by references to a classical education model and curriculum explanations.
- The formation-focused language (“formation,” “collaboration in their formation”) is present in the Catholic-school-context materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon, category 2): formation, truth/goodness/beauty as real, scholé/restful learning, contemplation, human flourishing, moral imagination, and virtue-related aims. The site materials emphasize formation and a classical framing, though explicit phrasing on “virtue” or “leisure/wisdom” as primary telos is not consistently explicit in public texts.
- Negative keywords: none explicitly evidenced.
- Why this rating
- The school signals formation and a scholé-like orientation in its overall classical framing, but explicit articulation of the classical telos (virtue + wisdom as central aims) and comprehensive emphasis on the true/concrete transcendent aims are not exhaustively documented in public pages. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials explicitly name St. Leo as following a “classical education model” and point to curricular explanations hosted publicly. This signals a curriculum rooted in classical design.
- There are explicit references to curriculum-focused documents (e.g., What is your child made-for curriculum) and calendars/handbooks, indicating structured curricular planning.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon, category 3): Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; Great Books; primary sources; integration and wonder). The public pages do not consistently document Great Books, primary texts, or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium elements; the phrase “classical education model” is present but lacks explicit Great Books references in the accessible content. Therefore, only partial alignment with the canonical Curriculum indicators.
- Negative keywords: indications of modern/repurposed curriculum language (like “textbook-based” or non-Great-Books emphasis) are not clearly evidenced; thus no clear negative signals are present in the crawl.
- Why this rating
- The school presents a classical-leaning curriculum identity, but the public materials do not consistently demonstrate the full spectrum of canonical classical curriculum markers (Great Books, Great Conversation, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium, etc.). This makes it SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than

CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize a classically designed education model but do not provide explicit details about pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, liturgical/restful teaching (Scholé) rhythms, chanting, or memorization practices as a regular pedagogy. The site lacks explicit statements of Socratic dialogues, seminars, or memory-chanting practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon, category 4): Socratic dialogue, narration, recitation, chanting, scholé, restfulness, memory work, rhetoric training, upper-school rhetoric, etc. The public site does not routinely state these pedagogical methods; thus, those keywords do not appear in the crawl in a clearly documented way.
- Negative keywords: the public materials do not show a dominant shift to project-based or highly experiential learning as the sole approach; but absence of explicit traditional methods is a concern. The lack of explicit Socratic/seminar language in the crawl edges toward not fully meeting the Pedagogy element as defined.
- Why this rating
- While the school claims a classical model, the explicit Pedagogy indicators (Socratic seminars, scholé-focused, memorization/chanting) are not evidenced in the accessible crawl content. This suggests NOT CLASSICAL in pedagogy, given the absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals beyond a general “classical education model.”

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl content does not publicly describe a faculty portrait, living curriculum, or a “faculty as mentors” philosophy, nor teacher formation in classical pedagogy in the publicly accessible pages. The presence of calendars, handbooks, uniforms, and PTO materials does not substitute for explicit faculty modeling language.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (category 5 from the lexicon): teachers as models of virtue; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; collegiality; mentorship; master-apprentice; etc. These are not explicitly evidenced in the St. Leo crawl content.
- Negative keywords: None explicit in school-public materials; however, absence of the “living curriculum” and “model teachers” signals suggests not meeting this element as published.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit public-facing statements about faculty as living curriculum or teachers as virtuous models places the school outside the explicit Faculty element according to the classical rubric. Hence NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school’s pages include parent-facing resources: Preschool admissions details, calendars, tuition, uniform guidelines, Family Handbook, and PTO link. These indicate a structured partnership with families and opportunities for parent involvement.
- The presence of a School PTO and Family Handbook signals active parental engagement and a community orientation, even if the exact “co-teachers” formulation is not explicitly stated in public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (category 6 from the lexicon): Partnership with families, formation of affections, cultural transmission, parent formation, home-school collaboration, family rhythms, household worship, parental involvement, living tradition in the family. Some of these are reflected by PTO/Handbook content, though not every element is spelled out publicly.
- Negative keywords: none clearly evidenced; however, explicit “parents as co-teachers” language is not visibly present in the crawl, which dampens full alignment with category 6’s ideal.

- Why this rating
- The public materials show active parental involvement channels (PTO, Family Handbook, admissions information), indicating engagement with parents and community. Still, the specific classical rubric expectation of parents as co-teachers or explicit formation-by-parents language is not consistently evidenced. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment

- CLASSICAL: Element 1 (Religious Foundations) only.
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: Categories 2, 3, and 6.
- NOT CLASSICAL: Categories 4 and 5.
- Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools)

- Expand explicit articulation of classical pedagogy in public materials:
- Add explicit references to Great Books and Great Conversation in the curriculum narrative, including a clear statement of how Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) are embedded in the curriculum. Include sample courses or units that utilize classic texts at appropriate grade bands. This would push Element 3 toward CLASSICAL and Element 4 toward CLASSICAL.
- Make Socratic pedagogy and scholé practices explicit:
- Publish concrete descriptions of pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, memory/recitation practices, and guided-discussion formats in upper grades. Include examples of daily or weekly routines that incorporate contemplative rest (scholé) and structured discourse. This would push Element 4 toward CLASSICAL and Element 2 closer to CLASSICAL.
- Strengthen the faculty narrative:
- Include a “living curriculum” statement for faculty and a portrait of the teacher that details teacher formation, mentorship, and collaborative culture (e.g., faculty seminars, mentoring programs). This could elevate Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
- Deepen parental partnership:
- Formalize explicit “parents as co-teachers” language, parent education programs (book studies, lectures on classical education), and structured opportunities for parents to participate as co-educators. Expand the published commitments to liturgical rhythms and family formation to lift Element 6 toward CLASSICAL.
- Emphasize Great Books, Great Conversation, and historical engagement in the curriculum:
- Publish a formal “Great Books/Great Conversation” plan with a proposed reading list, historical integration, and cross-disciplinary connections to history, literature, philosophy, and theology. This would strengthen Element 3 and overall alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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